satisfying to the Indian. Nothing more is to be known except that the man he will meet *is* a saint. I have often tried to explain this attitude to Westerners. First, they tell me that they do not travel only to meet a saint. And before they meet him, they would like to know who he is, what he does with himself, how he spends his time, and many other things which he must do besides being a saint, just as we are all men and also have occupations.

The learned man in the East has a prestige of his own which far exceeds the prestige which is bestowed to any other calling. It appears that a learned man in the West does not stand in the same position. To be simply known as learned is enough in the East to earn respect from all around. To be sure, in the West, too, the learned man is cared for, sought after, and honored, but in the world of today, he is also a victim of liberalization and leveling. The learned man has prestige, but only in the sense that he is well paid, in terms of money. The point is that one can pay a learned man much more today than he has ever been paid before, but that does not exhaust the meaning of genuine respect, which is due in society irrespective of his wealth or poverty.

Another image that I have of the Western man in this age of democracy, equality, and freedom is that of an undue leveling of all personal heirarchies in matters of mind and achievements. A certain kind of personal heirarchy between men and minds is good both for the individual and for man. This needs a little explanation. It occurs to me, and I may be all wrong in this, that the individuals in the West today do not have the same kind of personal adoration for a philosopher like Plato, Kant, or any other great thinker of the past as I have for them. Being in the same field, I find I keep myself at a distance from them and that I feel quite at the bottom while they are all at the top. This would be so even if I were the greatest philosopher of the twentieth century. I have a hierarchy in my mind with regard to their minds and achievements. I find this lacking in the West. I sometimes wonder if a sculptor or painter of any advanced Western country realizes in his own mind a sense of heirarchy with regard to Michelangelo, Leonardo da Vinci or Raphael. But I suspect that an individual who is a great Western sculptor or a painter might feel that he is equally great if not greater. He will perhaps feel that only his creations and tools and designs are different, and there is no difference in greatness. He might be equally great.

This leveling of the individuals to which I am referring above is perhaps due to the importance of the "public." It is the public that sets up standards in all spheres of our lives, and it is strange to say